

A fast proclaimed. Chap.viij. The Leuites charge.

10 And of the sonnes of Shelomith, the sonne of Josiphiah, and with him an hundred and threescore males.

11 And of the sonnes of Sebai, Zechariah the sonne of Sebai, and with him twenty and eight males.

12 And of the sonnes of Azgad, Johanan || the sonne of Hakkatan, and with him an hundred and ten males.

13 And of the last sonnes of Adonikam, whose names are these: Elphelet, Jehiel, and Shemaiah, and with them threescore males.

14 Of the sonnes also of Bigvai, Uthai, and || Zabbud, and with them seuentie males.

15 ¶ And I gathered them together to the river, that runneth to Ahava, and there || abode wee in tents three dayes: and I viewed the people, and the Priests, and found there none of the sonnes of Leui.

16 Then sent I for Eliezer, for Aziel, for Shemaiah, and for Elnathan, and for Harib, and for Elnathan, and for Nathan, and for Zechariah, and for Meshullam, chiefe men: also for Harib, and for Elnathan, men of vnderstanding.

17 And I sent them with commandement vnto Iddo the chiefe at the place Casiphia, and I || told them what they should say vnto Iddo, and to his brethren the Nethinims, at the place Casiphia, that they should bring vnto vs ministers for the house of our God.

18 And by the good hand of our God vpon vs, they brought vs a man of vnderstanding, of the sonnes of Mahli the sonne of Leui, the sonne of Israel, and Sherebiah, with his sonnes, and his brethren, eightene.

19 And Hashabiah, and with him Jethaiah of the sonnes of Merari, his brethren and their sonnes, twentie.

20 * Also of the Nethinims, whom David, and the Princes had appointed for the seruice of the Leuites, two hundred and twentie Nethinims: all of them were expressed by name.

21 ¶ Then I proclaimed a fast there, at the river Ahava, that wee might afflict our selues before our God, to seeke of him a right way for vs, and for our little ones and for all our substance.

22 For I was ashamed to require of the king a band of souldiers and horsemen, to helpe vs against the enemie in the way: because wee had spoken vnto

the king, saying, The hand of our God is vpon all them for good, that seeke him, but his power and his wrath is against all them that forsake him.

23 So we fasted, and besought our God for this, and hee was intreated of vs.

24 ¶ Then I separated twelue of the chiefe of the Priests, Sherebiah, Hashabiah, and ten of their brethren with them,

25 And weighed vnto them the siluer and the gold, and the vessels, euen the offering of the house of our God, which the king and his counsellours, and his lords, and all Israel there present, had offered:

26 I euen weighed vnto their hand, sixe hundred and fifty talents of siluer, and siluer vessels an hundred talents, and of gold an hundred talents:

27 Also twenty basons of gold, of a thousand drammes, and two vessels of † fine copper, † precious as gold.

28 And I said vnto them, Yee are holy vnto the LORD, the vessels are holy also, and the siluer and the gold are a free-will offering vnto the LORD God of your fathers.

29 Watch ye, and keepe them, vntill yee weigh them before the chiefe of the Priests, and the Leuites, and chiefe of the fathers of Israel at Jerusalem, in the chambers of the house of the LORD.

30 So tooke the Priests and the Leuites the weight of the siluer and the gold, and the vessels, to bring them to Jerusalem, vnto the house of our God.

31 ¶ Then wee departed from the river of Ahava, on the twelfth day of the first moneth, to goe vnto Jerusalem: and the hand of our God was vpon vs, and hee deliuered vs from the hand of the enemie, and of such as lay in wait by the way.

32 And we came to Jerusalem, and abode there three dayes.

33 ¶ Now on the fourth day was the siluer and the gold, and the vessels weighed in the house of our God, by the hand of Meremoth the sonne of Uriah the Priest, and with him was Eleazar the sonne of Phinchas, and with them was Jozabad the sonne of Jethua, and Rodiah the sonne of Binnui, Leuites:

34 By number, and by weight of euerij

|| Or, the youngest son.

|| Or, Zaccur, as some read.

|| Or pitched.

† Hebr. I put words in their mouth.

* See Chap. 2. 43.

† Hebr. yeklow or saining brass. † Hebr. desic cable.

uery one: and all the weight was written at that time.

35 **A**llo the children of those that had bene caried away which were come out of the captiuitie, offered burnt offerings vnto the God of Israel, twelue bullocks for all Israel, ninetie and fixe rammes, twentie and seuen lambes, twelue hee goats for a sinne offering: All this was a burnt offering vnto the LORD.

36 **A**nd they deliuered the Kings commissions vnto the kings lieutenants, and to the gouernours on this side the riuer, and they furthered the people, and the house of God.

CHAP. IX.

1 Ezra moumeth for the affinitie of the people with strangers. 5 He prayeth vnto God with confession of finnes.

NOwe when these things were done, the Princes came to me, saying, The people of Israel, and the priests and the Leuites, haue not separated themselves from the people of the lands, doing according to their abominations, euen of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Jebusites, the Ammonites, the Moabites, the Egyptians, and the Amorites.

2 For they haue taken of their daughters for themselves, and for their sonnes: so that the holy seed haue mingled themselves with the people of those lands, yea the hand of the princes and rulers hath bin chiefe in this trespassse.

3 And when I heard this thing, I rent my garment and my mantle, and pluckt off the haire of my head, and of my beard, and sate dolefully astounded.

4 Then were assembled vnto me euery one that trembled at the words of the God of Israel, because of the transgression of those that had bene caried away, and I sate astounded, vntill the evening sacrifice.

5 **A**nd at the evening sacrifice, I arose by from my heauiness, and hauing rent my garment and my mantle, I fell vpon my knees, and spread out my hands vnto the LORD my God,

6 And said, O my God, I am ashamed, and blush to lift vp my face to thee, my God: for our iniquities are increased ouer our head, and our trespassse is

groben by vnto the heauens.

7 Since the dayes of our fathers, haue wee bene in a great trespassse vnto this day, & for our iniquities haue we, our kings and our priests, bin deliuered into the hand of the kings of the lands, to the sword, to captiuitie, and to a spoile, and to confusion of face, as it is this day.

8 And now for a little space grace hath bene shewed from the LORD our God, to leaue vs a remnant to escape, and to giue vs a name in his holy place, that our God may lighten our eyes, and giue vs a little reuiuing in our bondage:

9 For wee were bondmen, yet our God hath not forsaken vs in our bondage, but hath extended mercie vnto vs in the sight of the kings of Persia, to giue vs a reuiuing to set by the house of our God, and to repaire the desolations thereof, and to giue vs a wall in Judah and in Jerusalem.

10 And now, O our God, what shal we say after this: for we haue forsaken thy commandements,

11 which thou hast commanded by thy seruants the prophets, saying, *The land vnto which ye go to possesse it, is an vncleane land, with the filthinesse of the people of the lands, with their abominations, which haue filled it from one end to another, with their vncleannesse.

12 Nowe therefore giue not your daughters vnto their sonnes, neither take their daughters vnto your sonnes, nor seeke their peace or their wealth for euer: that ye may bee strong, and eate the good of the land, and leaue it for an inheritance to your children for euer.

13 And after all that is come vpon vs, for our euill deeds, and for our great trespassse, seeing that thou, our God, hast punished vs lesse, then our iniquities deserue, and hast giuen vs such deliuerance as this:

14 Should wee againe breake thy commandements, and ioyne in affinitie with the people of these abominations: Wouldest thou not be angry with vs, til thou haddest consumed vs, so that there should be no remnant, nor escaping:

15 O LORD God of Israel, thou art righteous, for wee remaine yet escaped, as it is this day: Behold, we are before thee in our trespassses: for wee can not stand before thee, because of this.

† Heb. moment.

|| Or, a pime That is, a constant and sure abode.

† Heb. to see vpon.

† Heb. by the hand of thy seruants.

* Exod. 23. 32, deut. 7. 3

† Heb. from mouth to mouth.

† Heb. hast withheld beneath our iniquities.

C H A P. X.

1 Shechaniah encourageth Ezra to reforme the strange mariages. 6 Ezra mourning, assemblith the people. 9 The people at the exhortation of Ezra, repent and promise amendment. 15 The care to performe it. 18 The names of them who had married strange wiues.

NOW when Ezra had prayed, and when he had confessed, weeping, and casting himselfe downe before the house of God, there assembled vnto him out of Israel, a very great congregation of men, and women, and children: for the people wept very sore.

† Hebr. wept a great weeping.

2 And Shechaniah the sonne of Jehiel, one of the sonnes of Elam, answered and said vnto Ezra, Wee haue trespassed against our God, and haue taken strange wiues, of the people of the land: yet now there is hope in Israel concerning this thing.

† Hebr. to bring forth

3 Now therefore let vs make a coveniant with our God, † to put away all the wiues & such as are borne of them, according to the counsell of my lord, and of those that tremble at the commaundment of our God, and lee it be done according to the Law.

4 Arise, for this matter belongeth vnto thee, wee also will be with thee: be of good courage, and doe it.

5 Then arose Ezra, and made the chiefe Priests, the Leuites, and all Israel to sweare, that they should doe according to this word: and they sware.

6 Then Ezra rose vp from before the house of God, and went into the chamber of Iohanan, the sonne of Eliashib: and when hee came thither, hee did eate no bread, nor drinke water: for hee mourned because of the transgression of them that had bene caried away.

7 And they made proclamation throughout Iudah and Jerusalem, vnto all the children of the captiuitie, that they should gather themselves together vnto Jerusalem:

8 And that whosoener would not come within three dayes, according to the counsell of the Princes, and the Elders, all his substance should be † forfeited, and himselfe separated from the congregation of those that had bene caried away.

† Heb. denoted.

9 Then all the men of Iudah and Benjamin, gathered themselves

together vnto Jerusalem, within three dayes: it was the ninth moneth, on the twentieth day of the moneth, and all the people sate in the streete of the house of God, trembling because of this matter, and for † the great raine.

† Hebr. the shower.

10 And Ezra the Priest stood vp, and said vnto them, Wee haue transgressed, and † haue taken strange wiues, to encrease the trespass of Israel.

† Hebr. haue caused to dwell, or haue brought backe.

11 Now therefore make confession vnto the LORD God of your fathers, and doe his pleasure: and separate your selues from the people of the land, and from the strange wiues.

12 Then all the congregation answered, and said with a loude voice, As thou hast said, so must we doe:

13 But the people are many, and it is a time of much raine, and we are not able to stand without: neither is this a worke of one day or two: for † wee are many that haue transgressed in this thing.

|| Or, wee haue greatly offended in this thing.

14 Let now our rulers of all the congregation stand, and let all them which haue taken strange wiues in our cities, come at appointed times, & with them the Elders of euery citie, and the Iudges thereof vntill the fierce wrath of our God † for this matter, be turned from vs.

|| Or, till this matter be dispatched.

15 Surely Jonathan the sonne of Alahel, and Jahaziah the sonne of Tehuah, † were employed about this matter: and Beshullani, and Shabbethai the Leuite, helped them.

† Heb. stood.

16 And the children of the captiuitie did so: and Ezra the Priest, with certaine chiefe of the fathers, after the house of their fathers, and all of them by their names, were separated, and sate downe in the first day of the tenth moneth to examine the matter.

17 And they made an ende, with all the men that had taken strange wiues, by the first day of the first moneth.

18 And among the sonnes of the Priestes, there were found that had taken strange wiues: namely, of the sons of Ieshua the sonne of Jozadak, and his brethren, Maasiah, and Elieser, and Jarib, and Gedaliah.

19 And they gaue their hands, that they would put away their wiues: and being guiltie, they offered a ramme of the flocke for their trespass.

20 And of the sonnes of Immer, Hanani, and Zebadiah:

21 And

Who put away Nehemiah. strange wiues.

21 And of the sonnes of Harim, Maasiah, and Eliah, and Shemaiah, and Jehiel, and Uziah.

22 And of the sonnes of Pachur: Choenai, Maasiah, Ishmael, Bethaneel, Jozabad and Eliah.

23 Also of the Leuites: Jozabad, and Shimei, and Belsiah (the same is Belsiah) Bethahiah, Judah, and Eliezer.

24 Of the singers also, Eliashib, and of the porters, Shallum, and Telem, and Uri.

25 Moreover of Israel, of the sonnes of Parosh, Barniah, and Jehiah, and Malchiah, and Giamin, and Eleazar, and Malchiah, and Benajah.

26 And of the sonnes of Elam: Pateniah, Zechariah, and Jehiel, and Abdi, and Jeremoth, and Eliah.

27 And of the sonnes of Zattu: Elioenai, Eliashib, Mattaniah, and Jeremoth, and Zabad, and Aziza.

28 Of the sonnes also of Bebai: Jehohanan, Hananiah, Zabbai, & Athlai.

29 And of the sonnes of Bani: Mesullam, Malluch, and Adaiah, Jashub, and Sheal, and Ramoth.

30 And of the sonnes of Pahath Moab: Adna, and Chelai, Benajah,

Maasiah, Mattaniah, Bezalcel, and Bunui, and Hanasseh.

31 And of the sonnes of Harim: Eliezer, Ishuah, Malchiah, Shemaiah, Shimeon,

32 Benjamin, Malluch, and Shemaiah.

33 Of the sonnes of hathum: Patenai, Mattatha, Zabad, Elphelet, Jeremai, Hanasseh, and Shimei.

34 Of the sonnes of Bani: Maadai, Amram, and Uel,

35 Benajah, Bedaiah, Chelluh,

36 Uanah, Peremoth, Eliashib,

37 Mattaniah, Mattenai, and Jaasau,

38 And Bani, and Bennui, Shimei,

39 And Shelemiah, and Nathan, and Adaiah,

40 || Machnadebai, Shashai, Shara,

41 Azazel, and Shelemiah, Shemaiah,

42 Shallum, Amariah, and Joseph.

43 Of the sonnes of Rebo, Jehiel, Mattathiah, Zabad, Zebina, Jadan, and Joel, Benajah.

44 All these had taken strange wiues: and some of them had wiues, by whom they had children.

|| Or, Machnadebai, according to some copies.



THE BOOKE OF Nehemiah.

CHAP. I.

1 Nehemiah, vnderstanding by Hanani, the misery of Ierusalem, mourneth, fasteth and prayeth. 5 His prayer.



he words of Nehemiah the sonne of hachabiah. And it came to passe in the moneth Chisleu, in the twentieth yere, as I was in Shushan the palace;

2 That Hanani, one of my brethren came, he and certaine men of Judah, and

I asked them concerning the Iewes that had escaped, which were left of the captiuitie, and concerning Ierusalem.

3 And they said vnto me, The remnant that are left of the captiuitie there in the prouince, are in great affliction and reproch: the wall of Ierusalem also * is broken downe, and the gates thereof are burnt with fire.

4 And it came to passe when I heard these words, that I late downe and wept, and mourned certaine dayes, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heauen,

5 And said, I beseech thee, * O LORD God of heauen, the great and terrible

* 2. King. 25. 9.

* Dan. 9. 4.

terrible God, that keepeth covenant and mercie for them that loue him, and oblerue his commandements:

6 Let thine eare now be attentue, and thine eyes open, that thou mayest heare the prayer of thy seruant, which I pray before thee now, day and night, for the chudren of Israel thy seruants, and confesse the finnes of the chudren of Israel, which wee haue sinned against thee: both I, and my fathers house haue sinned.

7 We haue dealt very corruptly against thee, and haue not kept the commandements, nor the statutes, nor the iudgements, which thou commandedst thy seruant Moses.

8 Remember, I beseech thee, the word that thou commandedst thy seruant Moses, saying, * If ye transgresse, I will scatter you abroad among the nations:

9 But if ye turne vnto me, and keepe my commandements, and doe them: * though there were of you cast out vnto the vtermost part of the heauen, yet will I gather them from thence, and will bring them vnto the place that I haue chosen, to set my Name there.

10 Now these are thy seruants, and thy people, whom thou hast redeemed by thy great power, and by thy strong hand.

11 O LORD, I beseech thee, let now thine eare be attentue to the prayer of thy seruant, and to the prayer of thy seruants, who desire to feare thy name: and prosper, I pray thee, thy seruant this day, and grant him mercie in the sight of this man. For I was the kings cup-bearer.

CHAP. II.

1 Artaxerxes vnderstanding the cause of Nehemiahs sadnesse, sendeth him with letters and commission to Ierusalem. 9 Nehemiah, to the griefe of the enemies, commeth to Ierusalem. 12 Hee vieweth secretly the ruines of the walles. 17 He incited the Iewes to build in despite of the enemies.

AND it came to passe, in the moneth Nisan, in the twentieth yeere of Artaxerxes the king, that wine was before him: and I tooke vp the wine, and gaue it vnto the king: now I had not bene beforetime sad in his presence.

2 Wherefore the king said vnto me, Why is thy countenance sadde, seeing thou art not sick: this is nothing else but sorrow of heart. Then I was very sore afraid,

3 And said vnto the king, Let the king liue for euer: Why should not my countenance be sad, when the city, the place of my fathers Sepulchres, lyeth waste, and the gates thereof are consumed with fire:

4 Then the king said vnto me, For what doest thou make request: So I prayed to the God of heauen.

5 And I said vnto the king, If it please the king, and if thy seruant haue found fauour in thy sight, that thou wouldest send me vnto Iudah vnto the City of my fathers sepulchres, that I may build it.

6 And the king saide vnto mee (the [†] Queene also sitting by him) For how long shall thy iourney bee: and when wilt thou returne: So it pleased the king to send me, and I set him a time.

7 Moreover I saide vnto the king, If it please the king, let letters be giuen mee to the gouernours beyond the Riuer, that they may conuey me ouer, till I come into Iudah:

8 And a letter vnto Asaph the keeper of the kings forrest, that he may giue me timber to make beames for the gates of the palace which appertained to the house, and for the wall of the Citie, and for the house that I shall enter into: And the king granted me, according to the good hand of my God vpon me.

9 Then I came to the gouernours beyond the riuer, and gaue them the kings letters: (now the king had sent captaines of the army, and horsemen with me.)

10 When Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the seruant, the Ammonite, heard of it, it grieved them exceedingly, that there was come a man, to seeke the welfare of the chudren of Israel.

11 So I came to Ierusalem, and was there three dayes.

12 And I arose in the night, I, and some few men with mee, neither tolde I any man what God had put in my heart to doe at Ierusalem: neither was there any beast with mee, save the beast that I rode vpon.

13 And I went out by night, by the gate of the valley, euen before the dragon

* Deut. 4.
5. & c.

* Deut. 30.
4.

† Hebr.
wise.